

WHITE GOLD / BIGG BOSS TELUGU



Presents



White Gold x Agnipariksha

TELUGU CASE STUDY

Prepared by Balavishal

BACKGROUND & OBJECTIVES

Background

Agni Pariksha is the pre-show audition stage for Bigg Boss Telugu. Out of the 50 people who go through this audition, one gets picked to enter the main show. White Gold became the first brand in the history of Telugu Bigg Boss to get a direct entry slot into Agni Pariksha for a common person, through our own contest. This gave us a rare shot at using one of the biggest entertainment platforms in the region to build our name.

Problem

When the campaign went live, our Telugu Instagram page had only 450 followers. It was clear from the start that we could not reach a mass audience by posting on our own page alone. We needed a way to amplify the contest, reach more people and drive more entries.

Objectives

We built this contest to hit brand awareness, not sales. Specifically, we wanted to:

Make people aware that a brand called White Gold exists.

Tell people that White Gold is sponsoring Bigg Boss, and is the brand giving a common person a shot at Agni Pariksha.

Designing the Contest

The contest went through many rounds of revision, built in close coordination with the Bigg Boss programming team. Two decisions shaped the final version.

Public post or Private upload?

The first big call was whether participants should post their audition videos publicly on their own social media, or just upload them privately. The Bigg Boss team suggested private upload. **We pushed back and went with public posting instead**, because that is what gets a brand noticed and creates noise. We knew this meant some people might skip it out of shyness about posting publicly, and we were fine with that trade-off.

Application Process?

Our first idea was to ask people to make a creative video promoting White Gold. The Bigg Boss team advised against this, saying it would be too hard for an average person to pull off. We simplified it instead. The final brief asked participants to open with the line "This is my audition for White Gold Bigg Boss Agni Pariksha contest," followed by their own talent-based audition video showing why they deserve a spot.

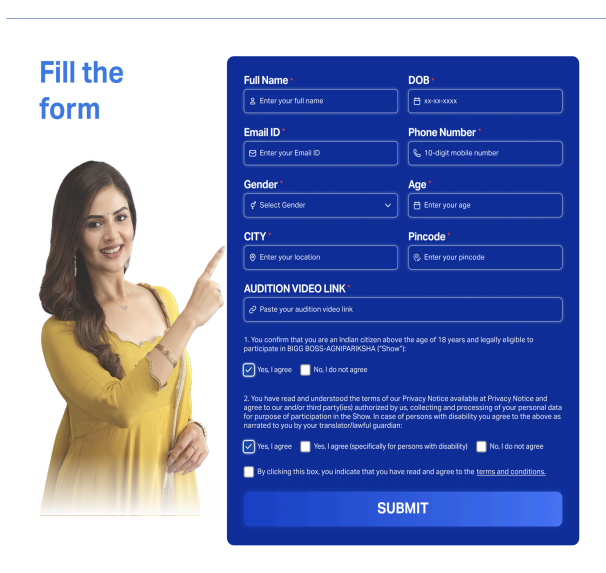
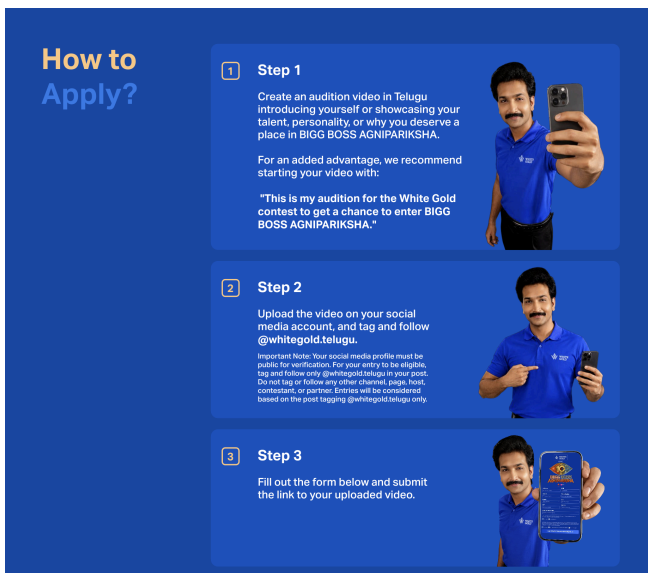


Example entry, 80.8K views

An audition, using the exact opening line from the brief, word for word.

Where people applied

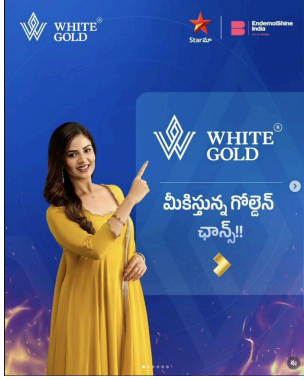
Our first priority was a microsite where people could apply. We designed the look and feel in-house, in the White Gold theme, and handed the backend build to our agency, Brand Story, who managed all the technical infrastructure. The microsite and its content were approved internally as well as by the Bigg Boss team.



The look of the microsite

Social Media Content for the Contest was Ready in Advance

We built an anticipation poster (a plain teaser post that gave nothing away, meant to go live before the contest opened), an official promo produced by the Star team using content we supplied, and a series of social posts. All of this was ready ahead of time so that once the campaign launched, all we had to do was publish.



SOCIAL POSTS SAMPLES

Three Layers of Amplification

Since our own page had only 450 followers, the only real option was to borrow reach from people who already had a Bigg Boss audience. We built this out in three layers.

1. Adi Reddy - BB COACH

An ex-Bigg Boss contestant and finalist who has been a Bigg Boss reviewer throughout his career. We used him as our main communication channel, but not as a paid spokesperson. He shared it the way he'd share any insider update with his audience.

500K

INSTAGRAM FOLLOWERS

260K

IG CHANNEL MEMBERS

900K

YOUTUBE SUBS

We closed a deal worth ₹3.5 lakh with him, covering both this contest and the promotion of the Agni Pariksha main show once it aired on TV. He put out more than 10 videos plus multiple stories.

2. Bigg Boss update pages.

We hired 7 to 8 dedicated Bigg Boss update pages, run by one team, for ₹90,000 for that week. They will post about the contest and explain the application process to their audience.

3. Outside influencers.

We used our existing contracts with influencers who had nothing to do with Bigg Boss. These deals already included a standard story-share deliverable as part of a normal brand collaboration, so we simply used that story share in advance to push the contest to a broader, non-Bigg Boss audience. These influencers will make their videos for us after the contest ends.

Implementation

The anticipation post went live around midday on Sunday, June 21st. Adi Reddy shared it on his story and with his community, telling people to follow the page because something was coming the next day. With his large following across Instagram and YouTube, a lot of people saw it. Our followers jumped from 450 to around 1,000 within 24 hours and the people started guessing what was coming up. Once the contest went live, applications came in fast. By the time our own team checked in, we already had around 100 entries.

Challenges

On day one, we ran into a technical problem: the submission form was accepting any plain text in place of an actual video link. We fixed this by the evening of the first day and restricted submissions to Instagram links only.

There was also confusion about how to apply properly. To fix this, we worked closely with Adi Reddy to put out "how-to" videos, things like tips and steps to get into Bigg Boss, and got the Bigg Boss update pages to do the same. We also started reposting well-made entries on our own page as a benchmark, and asked Adi Reddy and the update pages to point their followers to our page to see these reposts as a reference. By the middle of the second day, entry quality picked up noticeably, with people putting in real effort and following the format properly.

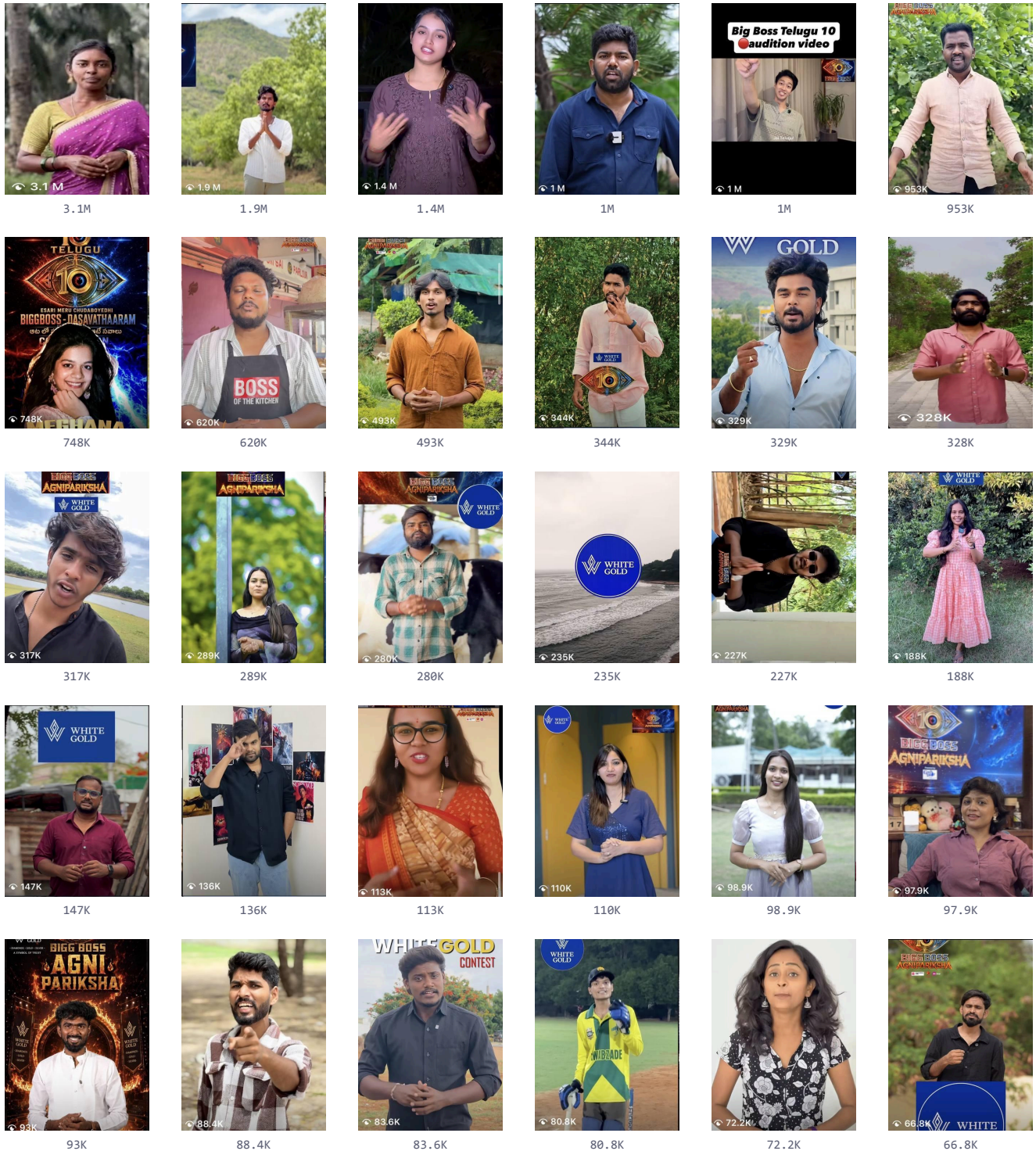
Entries by day

- Day 1: 600 entries
- Day 2: 600 more entries
- Day 3: a dip
- Day 4: another dip, followed by a push through outside-influencer Instagram stories, which caused a spike
- Throughout the first four days, we kept posting explainer videos and carousels on how to apply
- Last two days: countdown and last-date posters went out, and entries picked up again

The contest closed at 3,000 total entries, with a large share of them in proper format and clearly put together with effort.

What the entries looked like

A sample of audition entries found by searching "white gold big boss" on Instagram, with view counts at time of capture.





64.1K



64.1K



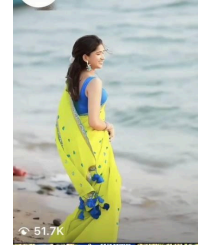
55.9K



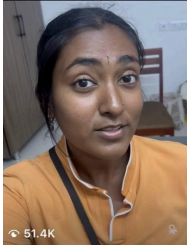
55.1K



55K



51.7K



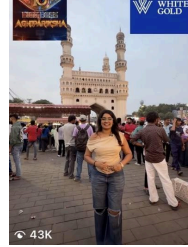
51.4K



50.6K



48.1K



43K



42.7K



40.3K



36.3K



34.6K



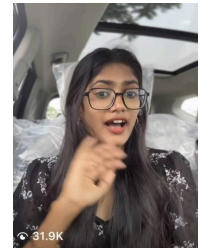
34.4K



34.4K



33.6K



31.9K



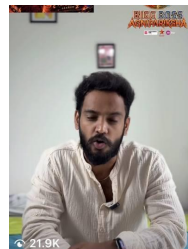
30K



24.8K



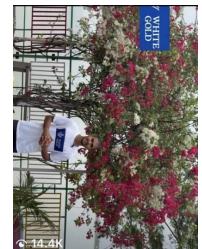
23.2K



21.9K



21.4K



14.4K

RESULTS

Results

There was no exact way to measure total views, so we searched "white gold big boss" on Instagram and pulled together the results we could find (samples on the previous page). **These samples alone crossed 1.5 crore views combined, and this is only a fraction of everything that was posted.** Our conservative estimate for total organic views across the whole campaign is 2 to 2.5 crore.

3,000
TOTAL ENTRIES

1.4M
INSTAGRAM REACH

3,000+
FOLLOWERS, FROM 450

1 to 6
CONTESTANT SEATS

2 to 2.5cr
EST. ORGANIC VIEWS

Our DMs were flooded and people tagged us constantly.

Star Maa and Jio Hotstar increased our brand's contestant allocation from 1 to 6 seats in Agni Pariksha, based on the volume and quality of entries we generated.

KEY TAKEAWAYS

Wayforward

We had aimed for 10,000 entries and didn't hit that number. But based on conversations with the influencers and ex-Bigg Boss contestants we worked with, we had reached the ceiling of the available audience. Every channel we had access to was used.

People across the Telugu states now know White Gold exists, but they don't yet know what we actually do. That's the next problem to solve: explaining our business clearly, showing what makes us different, and positioning the brand properly for future projects.

TEAM INVOLVED

Maleka Taj, Sunil Kumar, Balavishal, Akshay, Sharath, Sachin, Bhargavi, Praphul

CASE STUDY PREPARED BY

Balavishal